Class 8 Social Science – Chapter 2

Reshaping India’s Political Map

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इस अध्याय के सभी प्रश्नों के उत्तर सरल अंग्रेजी में दिए जाएँगे। साथ ही, प्रत्येक मुख्य टॉपिक से महत्वपूर्ण और संभावित परीक्षा-प्रश्नों के उत्तर भी शामिल किए जाएँगे। उत्तर आपकी अपलोड की गई पाठ्यपुस्तक पर आधारित हैं और कक्षा 8 के विद्यार्थियों के स्तर के अनुसार रखे गए हैं।

1. Chapter overview

This chapter explains how foreign invasions, new dynasties, regional kingdoms and rebellions changed the political map of India between the 11th and 17th centuries and beyond.

The chapter covers these main topics:

1. The Delhi Sultanate
2. Resistance to the Delhi Sultanate
3. The Vijayanagara Empire
4. The Mughal Empire and its rulers
5. Resistance to the Mughals
6. The Rajputs, Ahoms and Sikhs
7. Administration under the Sultanate and Mughals
8. People’s lives, agriculture, industries and trade

2. Important questions from the textbook

The Big Questions — Page 21

Q1. How did foreign invasions and the rise of new dynasties reshape India’s political boundaries during this period?

Answer: Foreign invasions and the rise of new dynasties changed India’s political boundaries. The Delhi Sultanate and the Mughal Empire expanded their territories. At the same time, kingdoms such as Vijayanagara, the Ahoms, the Rajputs and the Sikhs resisted them. As a result, many kingdoms rose and fell, and the political map of India kept changing.

Q2. How did Indian society respond to invasions? How did India’s economy adapt during times of political instability?

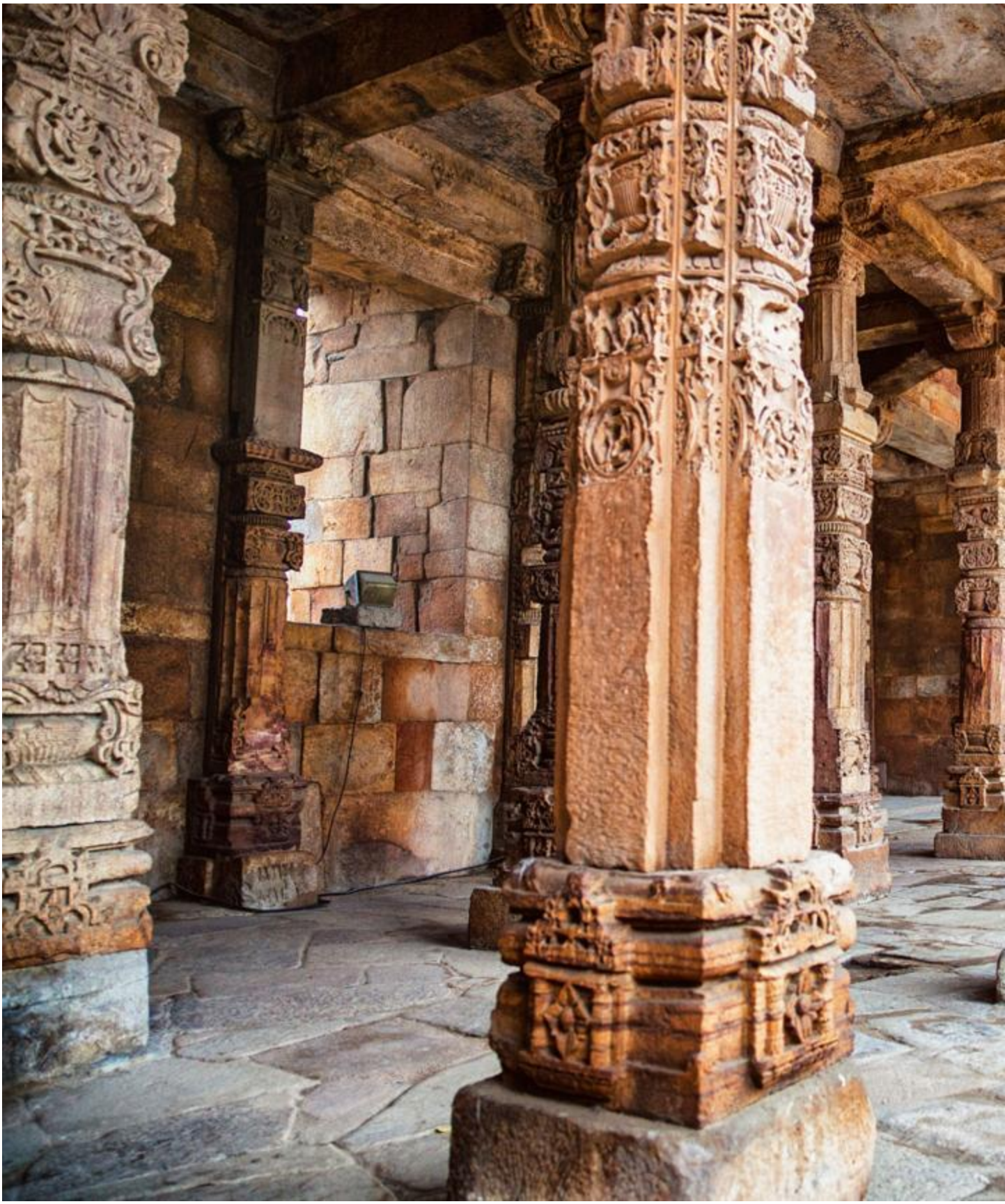
Answer: Indian society resisted invasions through wars, rebellions and alliances. Many communities protected their lands and traditions. Agriculture, crafts and trade continued despite political instability. Traders used credit systems such as hundi to transfer money safely. People also rebuilt towns, temples and other institutions.

Q3. What impact did this period have on the lives of the people?

Answer: This period brought both hardships and achievements. Wars caused destruction, loss of life, heavy taxes and the displacement of people. However, agriculture, trade, architecture, music, painting and literature also developed. Indian society adapted to changing political conditions and preserved many cultural traditions.

3. Rise and Fall of the Delhi Sultanate







Important questions and answers

Q1. What was the Delhi Sultanate?

Answer: The Delhi Sultanate was a kingdom ruled by Sultans from Delhi. It was established in 1206 and was ruled by five successive dynasties.

Q2. Name the five dynasties of the Delhi Sultanate.

Answer: The five dynasties were:

1. Mamluk or Slave Dynasty
2. Khilji Dynasty
3. Tughlaq Dynasty
4. Sayyid Dynasty
5. Lodi Dynasty

Q3. Who was Prithviraj Chauhan?

Answer: Prithviraj Chauhan was a ruler of parts of northwestern India. His defeat in 1192 helped pave the way for the establishment of the Delhi Sultanate.

Q4. Why was Delhi important during the Sultanate period?

Answer: Delhi became an important political centre of northern India. The Sultans ruled their territories from Delhi and used it as their main centre of administration.

Q5. Who was Ala-ud-din Khilji?

Answer: Ala-ud-din Khilji was a powerful Sultan of Delhi. He conquered large areas of northern and central India and repelled several Mongol invasions. His general Malik Kafur led military campaigns in southern India.

Q6. Who was Malik Kafur?

Answer: Malik Kafur was a slave-general of Ala-ud-din Khilji. He led military campaigns in southern India and brought wealth from conquered kingdoms to the Delhi Sultanate.

Q7. Why did the Sultans fight wars?

Answer: The Sultans fought wars to expand their territories, gain wealth, defeat their enemies and strengthen their power.

Q8. Why was political instability common during the Delhi Sultanate?

Answer: Political instability was common because rulers frequently fought for the throne. Many Sultans gained power by removing or killing their predecessors. Wars and rebellions also weakened the Sultanate.

Q9. What was Muhammad bin Tughlaq's plan to shift the capital?

Answer: Muhammad bin Tughlaq shifted his capital from Delhi to Daulatabad, formerly called Devagiri. He may have believed that Daulatabad's central location would help him control his empire. People had to travel over 1,000 kilometres. Later, he shifted the capital back to Delhi.

Q10. What was token currency? Why did it fail under Muhammad bin Tughlaq?

Answer: Token currency was a system in which copper coins were given the value of silver or gold coins. The system failed because people made counterfeit copper coins. This created confusion in trade and damaged the economy.

Q11. What was the impact of the Delhi Sultanate's military campaigns?

Answer: Military campaigns caused destruction in many towns and villages. Temples and centres of learning were attacked, and wealth was taken away. The campaigns also helped the Sultanate expand its territories.

Q12. What was jizya?

Answer: Jizya was a tax imposed by some rulers on non-Muslim subjects. According to the textbook, it was associated with protection and exemption from military service, but it could also create a heavy economic and social burden.

Q13. Who was Timur? What happened during his invasion of India?

Answer: Timur was a Turkic-Mongol conqueror from Central Asia. He invaded northwestern India in 1398 and attacked Delhi. Many people were killed or enslaved, and the city suffered widespread destruction. Timur left India with great wealth.

Q14. Why did the Delhi Sultanate become weaker?

Answer: The Delhi Sultanate became weaker because of frequent wars, violent changes of rulers, rebellions and resistance from regional kingdoms. Its territory gradually shrank.

Short-answer revision

Question	Simple answer
When was the Delhi Sultanate established?	In 1206.
Who introduced token currency?	Muhammad bin Tughlaq.
Who led southern campaigns under Ala-ud-din Khilji?	Malik Kafur.

Who attacked Delhi in 1398?	Timur.
Which was the last dynasty of the Delhi Sultanate?	The Lodi Dynasty.

4. Resistance to the Delhi Sultanate







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Q1. Which kingdoms resisted the Delhi Sultanate?

Answer: The Eastern Ganga kingdom, the Hoysalas, the Rajput kingdoms and several regional Sultanates resisted the expansion of the Delhi Sultanate.

Q2. Who was Narasimhadeva I?

Answer: Narasimhadeva I was a powerful ruler of the Eastern Ganga kingdom of Kalinga. He resisted the Delhi Sultanate and defeated its governor of Bengal. He built the famous Sun Temple at Konark.

Q3. What was the importance of the Eastern Ganga kingdom?

Answer: The Eastern Ganga kingdom controlled Kalinga, which included present-day Odisha and parts of Bengal and Andhra Pradesh. It resisted the Delhi Sultanate and developed art and culture.

Q4. Who were the Musunuri Nayakas?

Answer: The Musunuri Nayakas were Telugu chieftains. They united with more than 75 other chieftains and expelled Muhammad bin Tughlaq's army from Warangal around 1330–1336.

Q5. Who were the Hoysalas?

Answer: The Hoysalas ruled parts of southern India, mainly present-day Karnataka. They resisted attacks by the Delhi Sultanate and built magnificent temples at Belur and Halebidu.

Q6. Why did the Hoysala kingdom decline?

Answer: The Hoysala kingdom weakened because of repeated attacks and internal conflicts. In the mid-14th century, it was absorbed into the Vijayanagara Empire.

Q7. What was the Bahmani Sultanate?

Answer: The Bahmani Sultanate was an independent regional Sultanate established in 1347. It controlled much of the Deccan for a time and challenged the authority of the Delhi Sultanate.

Q8. Who was Rana Kumbha?

Answer: Rana Kumbha was a ruler of Mewar in Rajasthan. He resisted invasions by regional Sultanates and built Kumbhalgarh Fort in the 15th century.

Q9. Why were forts often built on hills?

Answer: Hills provided natural protection and made it difficult for enemies to attack. High locations also helped soldiers observe approaching armies and defend their territory.

Q10. What does the construction of temples and forts tell us about regional kingdoms?

Answer: It shows that regional kingdoms had resources, skilled workers and strong cultural traditions. Temples represented religious and artistic achievements, while forts provided military security.

5. The Vijayanagara Empire







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Important questions and answers

Q1. Who founded the Vijayanagara Empire?

Answer: Harihara and Bukka Raya established an independent kingdom in southern India in the 14th century. It later became the Vijayanagara Empire.

Q2. Why did Harihara and Bukka Raya establish an independent kingdom?

Answer: They had served as governors under Muhammad bin Tughlaq. Later, they rejected Delhi's authority and established an independent kingdom in southern India.

Q3. Where was the capital of the Vijayanagara Empire?

Answer: Its capital was Vijayanagara, located at present-day Hampi in Karnataka.

Q4. Who was Krishnadevaraya?

Answer: Krishnadevaraya was the most celebrated ruler of the Vijayanagara Empire. Under him, the empire reached its peak in the 16th century. He strengthened the empire and supported literature, temples, art and architecture.

Q5. What were Krishnadevaraya's contributions to literature?

Answer: He patronised poets and scholars writing in Sanskrit, Telugu and Kannada. He also wrote a Telugu epic poem called Amuktamalyada, which discussed good governance.

Q6. What was the importance of the Vitthala Temple?

Answer: The Vitthala Temple was an important example of Vijayanagara architecture. It is famous for its grand hall and beautifully carved stone pillars, some of which produce different musical notes when struck.

Q7. What was the relationship between Vijayanagara and the Bahmani Sultanate?

Answer: The Bahmani Sultanate was a major rival of Vijayanagara. The two powers fought several wars. After the Bahmani Sultanate broke up, five independent Deccan Sultanates emerged.

Q8. Name the five Deccan Sultanates.

Answer: The five Deccan Sultanates were:

1. Bijapur
2. Golconda
3. Berar
4. Ahmednagar
5. Bidar

Q9. Why did foreign travellers visit Vijayanagara?

Answer: Foreign travellers visited Vijayanagara mainly for trade. Portuguese traders, in particular, sold horses to the kingdom.

Q10. What did Domingo Paes write about Vijayanagara?

Answer: Domingo Paes described Vijayanagara as a large and beautiful city. He mentioned its gardens, water channels, lakes, crowded streets and busy markets. He also praised the availability of goods.

Q11. What happened at the Battle of Talikota in 1565?

Answer: The Deccan Sultanates formed a coalition and defeated the Vijayanagara forces led by Ramaraya. The city was plundered and badly destroyed. The empire later fragmented into smaller regions ruled by Nayakas.

Q12. Who were the Nayakas?

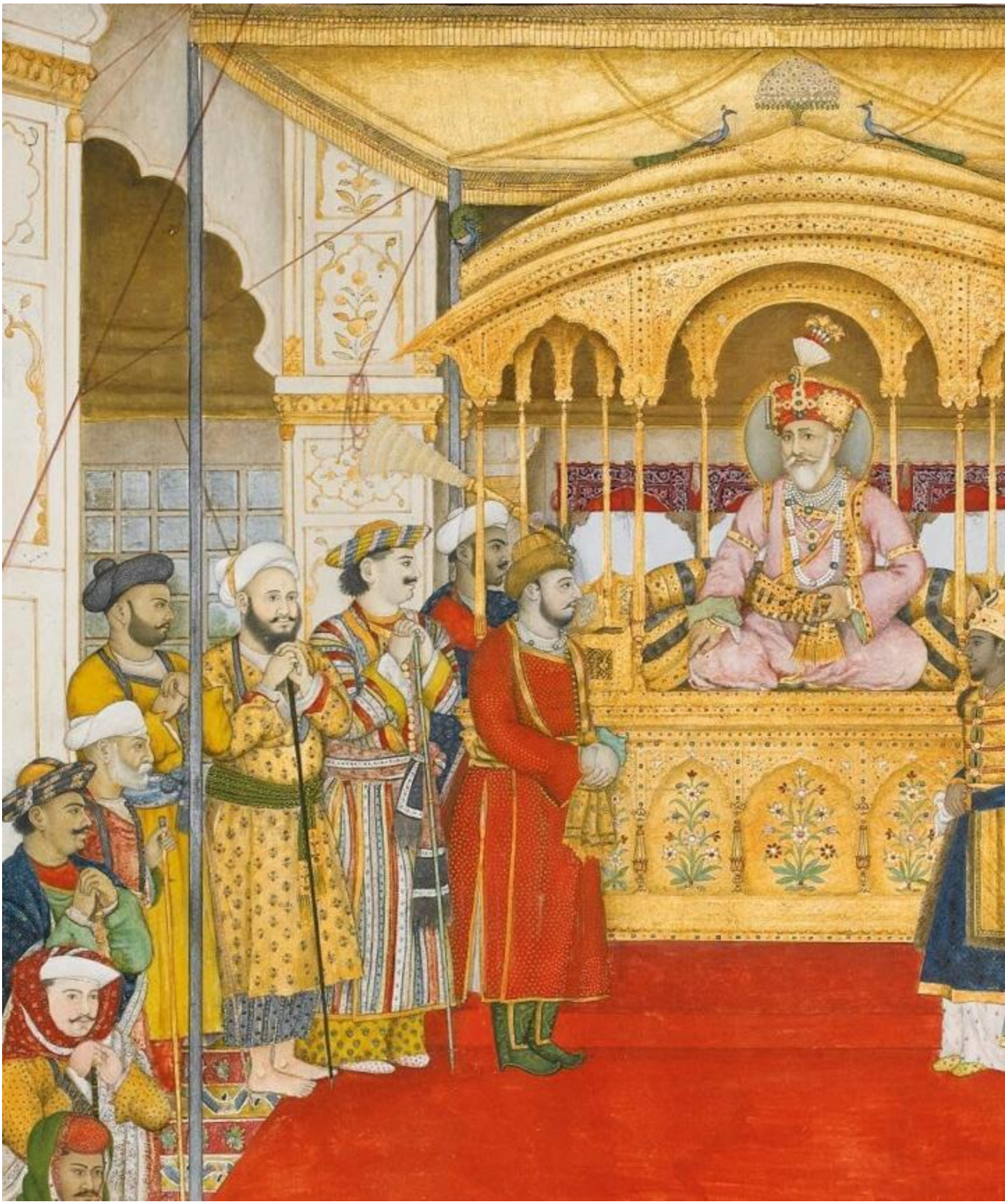
Answer: The Nayakas were former military governors who ruled smaller regions after the decline of the Vijayanagara Empire.

Q13. What might have happened if Vijayanagara had won the Battle of Talikota?

Answer: If Vijayanagara had won, it might have remained a powerful empire in southern India. Its capital could have continued to develop as a major centre of trade, art, literature and architecture. This is a possible historical outcome, not a known fact.

6. The Mughal Empire







A. Babur and the beginning of Mughal rule

Q1. Who was Babur?

Answer: Babur was a Turkic-Mongol ruler and military strategist. He defeated Ibrahim Lodi at the First Battle of Panipat in 1526 and established the foundation of the Mughal Empire in India.

Q2. Why was the First Battle of Panipat important?

Answer: The First Battle of Panipat took place in 1526. Babur defeated Ibrahim Lodi using gunpowder, field artillery and matchlock guns. This brought the Delhi Sultanate to an end and laid the foundation of Mughal rule.

Q3. What was the Baburnama?

Answer: The Baburnama was Babur's autobiography. It provides information about his life, interests, military campaigns and impressions of India.

Q4. What did Babur admire about India?

Answer: Babur recognised India's wealth, gold and silver, pleasant air during the rainy season, and skilled artisans and workers. These were among the reasons he decided to establish his empire in India.

B. Humayun and Sher Shah Suri

Q5. Who was Humayun?

Answer: Humayun was Babur's son. After becoming ruler, he struggled to maintain the Mughal Empire.

Q6. Who was Sher Shah Suri?

Answer: Sher Shah Suri was a powerful Afghan leader who established the Sur Empire over large parts of northern India. He introduced important reforms, but his empire was short-lived.

Q7. Who was Himu or Hemu?

Answer: Himu was a skilled military commander and chief minister under one of the last Suri rulers. He captured Delhi and briefly ruled under the name Hemchandra Vikramaditya. He was defeated in the Second Battle of Panipat.

C. Akbar

Q8. Who was Akbar?

Answer: Akbar became emperor at the age of 13 after the death of his father, Humayun. He expanded the Mughal Empire and used both military power and political strategies to strengthen it.

Q9. What was Akbar's policy of sulh-i-kul?

Answer: Sulh-i-kul means “peace with all”. It was a policy of tolerance towards different religions. Akbar promoted dialogue among different faiths and included regional leaders in his administration.

Q10. How did Akbar strengthen his empire?

Answer: Akbar used several methods:

- He conquered new territories.
- He formed marriage alliances with neighbouring kingdoms.
- He welcomed Rajput and regional leaders into his court.
- He abolished the jizya tax.
- He appointed officials from different backgrounds.
- He reorganised the administration.

Q11. What happened at Chittor during Akbar's reign?

Answer: Akbar besieged Chittor Fort for more than five months. After the fort fell, he ordered a massacre of civilians, according to the textbook. The Rajput defenders resisted strongly, and many women committed jauhar to avoid capture.

Q12. What was jauhar?

Answer: Jauhar was the act of Rajput women entering a mass fire to avoid capture and enslavement during a defeat. It was regarded in that historical context as an act of final resistance.

Q13. What was Akbar's contribution to literature?

Answer: Akbar encouraged scholars and supported the translation of Indian texts into Persian. His translation centre at Fatehpur Sikri arranged for works such as the Mahabharata, Ramayana, Bhagavad Gita and Panchatantra to be translated.

Q14. Why did Akbar follow different strategies from the earlier Delhi Sultans?

Answer: Akbar used military conquest as well as diplomacy, marriage alliances, religious tolerance and cooperation with regional rulers. These methods helped him gain wider support and govern a large empire.

D. Jahangir and Shah Jahan

Q15. Who was Jahangir?

Answer: Jahangir was Akbar's son. He shared his father's interest in art and architecture and tried to expand Mughal control into the Deccan.

Q16. Why is Shah Jahan remembered?

Answer: Shah Jahan is remembered especially for building the Taj Mahal at Agra. His reign also witnessed the construction of important buildings, including the Red Forts of Delhi and Agra.

Q17. Name two important architectural achievements of the Mughal period.

Answer: The Taj Mahal and Humayun's Tomb are two important architectural achievements of the Mughal period.

E. Aurangzeb

Q18. How did Aurangzeb become emperor?

Answer: Aurangzeb fought his brothers for the throne after Shah Jahan fell ill in 1657. He defeated Dara Shikoh, removed his other rivals and imprisoned Shah Jahan in Agra Fort. He became emperor in 1658.

Q19. What was the extent of the Mughal Empire under Aurangzeb?

Answer: Under Aurangzeb, the Mughal Empire reached its greatest territorial extent. He conquered parts of southern India but faced many rebellions.

Q20. Why did Mughal power decline after Aurangzeb's death?

Answer: Aurangzeb spent many years fighting wars, especially in the Deccan. Maintaining large armies drained the treasury and placed a heavy burden on the administration. Rebellions and regional resistance further weakened the empire after his death in 1707.

Q21. What religious policies did Aurangzeb follow?

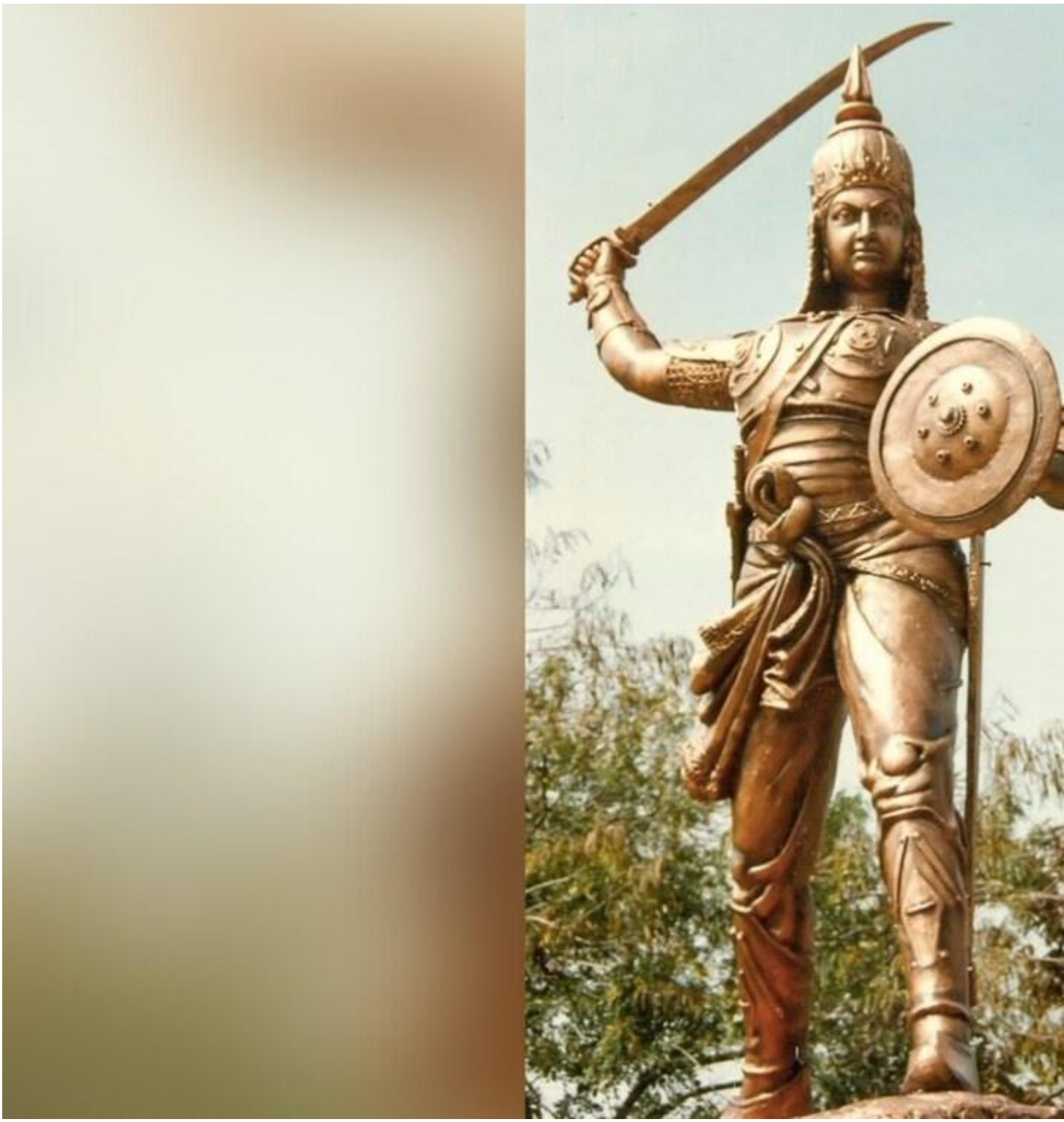
Answer: Aurangzeb reimposed the jizya tax on non-Muslims and a pilgrimage tax on Hindus. He also ordered the destruction of several temples and other religious institutions. The textbook notes that some scholars also point to political motives and instances of protection granted to certain temples.

Q22. How did Akbar and Aurangzeb differ in their religious policies?

Answer: Akbar promoted sulh-i-kul, abolished jizya and encouraged dialogue among religions. Aurangzeb reimposed jizya and introduced restrictions on certain religious and cultural practices. Their policies towards religious communities were therefore different.

7. Resistance to the Mughals

A. Peasants, tribal communities and Rani Durgavati







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Q1. Why did peasants rebel against the Mughals?

Answer: Many peasants rebelled because they suffered from harsh exploitation and heavy taxes. They wanted relief from oppression and unfair demands.

Q2. Which tribal communities resisted Mughal expansion?

Answer: The Bhils, Gonds, Santhals and Kochs were among the tribal communities that resisted attempts to annex their lands or impose taxes on them.

Q3. Who was Rani Durgavati?

Answer: Rani Durgavati was the brave queen of the Garha kingdom, one of the Gond kingdoms in central India. She ruled wisely, developed her kingdom and maintained a strong army.

Q4. How did Rani Durgavati fight against the Mughals?

Answer: In 1564, a general sent by Akbar attacked her kingdom. Although her forces were outnumbered and had inferior weapons, she fought bravely. When she was wounded, she took her own life to avoid capture.

Q5. Why is Rani Durgavati remembered today?

Answer: She is remembered for her courage, leadership, sacrifice and resistance against a powerful invading army.

B. The Rajputs

Q6. Who were the Rajputs?

Answer: The Rajputs were warrior ruling groups who established and defended kingdoms, especially in northwestern India. They often resisted invading forces and protected their independence.

Q7. Who was Rana Sanga?

Answer: Rana Sanga was a powerful ruler who united several Rajput clans. He won many battles against the Sultans but was eventually defeated by Babur at the Battle of Khanwa.

Q8. Who was Maharana Pratap?

Answer: Maharana Pratap was the ruler of Mewar. He refused to accept Mughal supremacy and became an important symbol of Rajput resistance.

Q9. What was the Battle of Haldighati?

Answer: The Battle of Haldighati took place in 1576. Maharana Pratap fought against the Mughal army. Although the Mughals gained the upper hand, Maharana Pratap escaped and continued resisting them.

Q10. What is guerrilla warfare?

Answer: Guerrilla warfare is a method of fighting in which small groups use their knowledge of the land to launch surprise attacks against larger armies.

Q11. How did the Bhils help Maharana Pratap?

Answer: The Bhils joined his army as archers and used their knowledge of the Aravalli hills to help him fight the Mughals. Their support was important in his resistance.

Q12. Did all Rajput rulers oppose the Mughals?

Answer: No. Some Rajput rulers formed alliances with the Mughals through diplomacy and marriage. Others, especially the rulers of Mewar, resisted Mughal dominance.

C. The Ahoms




BATTLE OF SARAIGHAT
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Q13. Who were the Ahoms?

Answer: The Ahoms migrated from present-day Myanmar to the Brahmaputra Valley in the 13th century. They established the Ahom kingdom in the region.

Q14. What was the paik system?

Answer: The paik system required able-bodied men to provide labour or military service to the state in exchange for land rights. It helped the Ahom rulers maintain a large force and build public infrastructure.

Q15. How did the Ahoms resist Mughal expansion?

Answer: The Ahoms used their knowledge of rivers, hills and dense forests. They employed guerrilla tactics and used their skills in boat warfare to defeat Mughal forces.

Q16. What happened at the Battle of Saraighat?

Answer: The Battle of Saraighat took place in 1671 on the Brahmaputra River near present-day Guwahati. The Ahom commander Lachit Borphukan and his soldiers defeated a much larger Mughal force. The Ahoms preserved their independence.

Q17. How did geography help the Ahoms?

Answer: The Brahmaputra River helped them fight with boats. Dense forests and hills made movement difficult for enemy armies. Their knowledge of the local terrain helped them organise surprise attacks and defend their kingdom.

Q18. How did the Ahoms contribute to society?

Answer: The Ahoms encouraged agriculture, adapted to local culture, supported diverse faiths and contributed to the cultural traditions of Assam.

D. The rise of the Sikhs






GURUDWARA SISGANJ SAHIB, DELHI

Q19. Who was Guru Nanak?

Answer: Guru Nanak was the founder of Sikhism. He taught the equality of all people, compassion and the oneness of God.

Q20. Why did the Sikh community become more militarised?

Answer: Some Mughal rulers persecuted Sikh Gurus. After Guru Arjan was tortured to death under Jahangir's orders, Guru Hargobind introduced martial training and formed a Sikh army.

Q21. Who was Guru Tegh Bahadur?

Answer: Guru Tegh Bahadur was the ninth Sikh Guru. He stood up for Kashmiri Pandits facing religious persecution. In 1675, he was executed in Delhi on Aurangzeb's orders after refusing to convert to Islam.

Q22. Who founded the Khalsa?

Answer: Guru Gobind Singh, the tenth and last Sikh Guru, established the Khalsa in 1699.

Q23. What were the main values of the Khalsa?

Answer: The Khalsa stood for justice, equality, courage and the defence of the Sikh faith.

Q24. What is the Guru Granth Sahib?

Answer: The Guru Granth Sahib is the sacred scripture of the Sikhs. It teaches truthfulness, compassion, humility, self-control and the oneness of God.

Q25. Who was Maharaja Ranjit Singh?

Answer: Maharaja Ranjit Singh united several Sikh confederacies around the beginning of the 19th century. He established a strong Sikh Empire and used military skill, diplomacy and religious tolerance to govern it.

Q26. Why is Guru Tegh Bahadur remembered?

Answer: Guru Tegh Bahadur is remembered for his courage and sacrifice in defending religious freedom. He stood up for people facing persecution, even at the cost of his life.

8. Administering India

A. Administration under the Delhi Sultanate

Q1. Who was the head of the Delhi Sultanate's administration?

Answer: The Sultan was the head of the administration. He held political and military authority and was responsible for protecting the territory, collecting taxes and attending to public affairs.

Q2. What was the role of the Sultan's ministers?

Answer: The ministers helped the Sultan manage different departments of the government.

Q3. What was the iqta system?

Answer: Under the iqta system, territories were assigned to nobles called iqtadars. They collected taxes and used part of the revenue to meet expenses. The remaining revenue was supposed to go to the Sultan's treasury.

Q4. What were the advantages of the iqta system?

Answer: It helped the Sultan collect revenue, maintain the army and appoint local administrators who remained loyal to the central government.

Q5. How did taxation affect peasants?

Answer: Peasants carried a heavy tax burden. Some accounts describe harsh methods used to collect land revenue, which caused hardship for farming communities.

B. Mughal administration

Q6. How did Akbar reorganise the Mughal administration?

Answer: Akbar divided administrative responsibilities among different ministers and organised the empire into provinces called subahs. Officials were given specific duties, and checks and balances helped improve administration.

Q7. What were the duties of the main Mughal officials?

Official	Main duty
Diwan	Managed finances
Mir Bakhshi	Managed military affairs
Khan-i-Saman	Looked after public works, trade, industry, agriculture and the royal household
Sadr	Looked after justice, religious affairs and education

Q8. What was a subah?

Answer: A subah was a province of the Mughal Empire. The empire was divided into provinces for easier administration.

Q9. What was the mansabdari system?

Answer: The mansabdari system was an administrative and military system introduced by Akbar. Mansabdars held ranks and were required to maintain a specified number of troops and animals for the state.

Q10. Who were mansabdars?

Answer: Mansabdars were officers who held ranks in the Mughal administration. They were expected to provide soldiers, horses, elephants and camels according to their assigned responsibilities.

Q11. What were jagirs?

Answer: Jagirs were land-revenue assignments given to mansabdars as payment. Mansabdars who received such assignments were also known as jagirdars.

Q12. What was the importance of the mansabdari system?

Answer: It helped the emperor assemble an army at short notice without maintaining a huge permanent central army. Regular inspections helped ensure that officers fulfilled their duties.

Q13. Who was Todar Mal?

Answer: Todar Mal was Akbar's finance minister. He introduced a systematic revenue system based on surveys of land, crop yields and prices. His reforms improved revenue collection and strengthened the state.

Q14. What was the Ain-i-Akbari?

Answer: The Ain-i-Akbari was written by Abul Fazl. It describes Akbar's administration and provides information about the mansabdari system and the organisation of the empire.

Q15. How was village administration different from central administration?

Answer: While the emperor and his officials managed the central and provincial administration, traditional systems of self-government continued largely undisturbed at the village level.

9. People’s Lives: Agriculture, Industries and Trade


N°17



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Q1. What were the main sources of India's economic prosperity during this period?

Answer: Agriculture, handicrafts, industries, temple-based economies and trade were the main sources of India's economic prosperity.

Q2. Why was agriculture important?

Answer: Agriculture was the mainstay of the Indian economy. Rulers collected land revenue from farmers to maintain their armies and administration.

Q3. What was the usual rate of land revenue?

Answer: Land revenue was generally about one-fifth of the produce, although some Sultans raised it to as much as one-half.

Q4. How did irrigation help agriculture?

Answer: Irrigation increased agricultural production and allowed farmers to grow different crops. Persian wheels, canals and other irrigation works helped supply water to fields.

Q5. Which crops were grown during this period?

Answer: Farmers grew rice, wheat, barley, pulses, sugarcane and spices. They also produced cotton, silk, wool, dyes, timber and jute.

Q6. What problems did peasants face?

Answer: Peasants faced heavy taxes, exploitation and severe famines. In some cases, they lost their land and became bonded labourers.

Q7. What products did Indian craftspeople make?

Answer: Craftspeople made textiles, weapons, utensils, ornaments, jewellery and many other useful goods.

Q8. Which ports were important for Indian trade?

Answer: Calicut, Mangalore, Surat, Masulipatnam and Hooghly were important coastal or riverside trading centres.

Q9. What goods did India export?

Answer: India exported textiles and many other agricultural and craft products. Indian goods were traded with merchants from different parts of the world.

Q10. What goods did India import?

Answer: India imported horses, silk, metals and various luxury goods. According to the textbook, India imported much less than it exported.

Q11. Who were the foreign merchants trading with India?

Answer: Merchants from Arabia, Persia and Central Asia settled in Indian ports and contributed to the growth of trade.

Q12. What was a hundi?

Answer: A hundi was a written instruction to make payment to a person. It allowed merchants to transfer money across political boundaries without carrying cash. It was an early form of a banking instrument.

Q13. How did the hundi system help traders?

Answer: It made the transfer of money safer and reduced the risk of losing wealth through robbery or plunder. It also helped traders conduct business across different kingdoms.

Q14. What role did temples play in economic life?

Answer: Temples were not only places of worship. They also supported markets, education, social activities and performing arts. They received land and wealth, helped develop irrigation facilities, provided accommodation for pilgrims and sometimes offered credit to merchants.

Q15. How did political instability affect trade and agriculture?

Answer: Wars and invasions damaged towns, villages and trade networks. People were sometimes forced to leave their homes. However, agriculture and trade continued, and merchants developed methods to conduct business across changing political boundaries.

Q16. How did Indian society preserve its culture during this period?

Answer: Communities maintained and revived their traditions while adapting to new conditions. Interactions between different communities also produced a shared cultural heritage. Architecture, music, painting and literature flourished.

Q17. Did everyone benefit equally from India's wealth?

Answer: No. Although India was economically prosperous, much of its wealth was concentrated among rulers, courtiers, high officials and merchants. Many peasants, craftspeople and labourers lived under difficult economic conditions.

10. Important terms and their meanings

These definitions are useful for one-mark questions and quick revision.

Term	Simple English meaning
Medieval period	A historical period between earlier and modern times; this textbook uses it broadly for the 11th–17th centuries.
Sultanate	A territory ruled by a Sultan.
Dynasty	A line of rulers belonging to the same family or ruling house.
Turkic	Related to peoples, languages and cultures associated with a large region of Central Asia.
Iconoclasm	Rejection or destruction of religious images.
Jizya	A tax imposed by some rulers on non-Muslim subjects.
Confederacy	An alliance of groups or rulers.

Guerrilla warfare	Fighting through small-group attacks and ambushes, often using knowledge of the land.
Paik system	A system of labour or military service in exchange for land rights.
Khalsa	A Sikh martial brotherhood established by Guru Gobind Singh.
Iqta	A territorial assignment for collecting revenue under the Delhi Sultanate.
Iqtadar	A person assigned an iqta.
Subah	A province of the Mughal Empire.
Mansab	A rank in the Mughal administrative and military system.
Mansabdar	An officer holding a mansab.
Jagir	A land-revenue assignment.
Jagirdar	A person who received a jagir.
Hundi	A written payment instrument used by merchants.
Jauhar	The historical practice of mass self-immolation by women to avoid capture.
Sulh-i-kul	“Peace with all”; Akbar's policy of religious tolerance.

11. Important dates and events

Learn these dates from the chapter's timeline on pages 22–23 and the later sections.

Year	Event
1192	Defeat of Prithviraj Chauhan
1206	Establishment of the Delhi Sultanate
1326	Re-establishment of the Mewar Kingdom, as shown in the textbook timeline
1336	Establishment of the Vijayanagara Empire
1347	Establishment of the Bahmani Sultanate
1398	Timur attacks Delhi
1498	Arrival of the Portuguese in India
1526	First Battle of Panipat; Babur defeats Ibrahim Lodi
1556	Second Battle of Panipat; Akbar's decisive victory
1564	Rani Durgavati's resistance against Akbar's forces
1565	Battle of Talikota; Vijayanagara suffers a major defeat
1576	Battle of Haldighati
1671	Battle of Saraighat; the Ahoms defeat the Mughals
1675	Execution of Guru Tegh Bahadur
1699	Formation of the Khalsa
1707	Death of Aurangzeb
1799	Establishment of the Sikh Empire, as shown in the textbook timeline

12. Complete textbook exercise: Questions and answers

The following answers cover the seven questions on page 59 of your uploaded chapter.

Question 1. Compare the political strategies of the Delhi Sultanate and the Mughals. What similarities and differences existed between them?

Answer:

Both the Delhi Sultanate and the Mughals used military campaigns to expand their territories. Both collected taxes and maintained armies to protect their power. Both also faced rebellions from regional rulers.

However, their strategies differed in some ways. The Delhi Sultans relied heavily on military conquest and territorial expansion. Akbar, on the other hand, combined military power with diplomacy, marriage alliances, cooperation with Rajput rulers and religious tolerance. He also reorganised the administration to strengthen the Mughal Empire.

Question 2. Why did kingdoms like the Vijayanagara Empire and the Ahom Kingdom manage to resist conquest for a longer time compared to others? What geographical, military, and social factors contributed to their success?

Answer:

The Vijayanagara and Ahom kingdoms resisted conquest because of their strong armies, capable leaders and knowledge of their surroundings.

Vijayanagara developed strong political and military institutions and defended its territories against rival powers. The Ahoms used the Brahmaputra River, hills and dense forests to their advantage. Their paik system helped them organise labour and military service. Both kingdoms also received support from their local communities.

Question 3. Imagine you are a scholar in the court of Akbar or Krishnadevaraya. Write a letter to a friend describing the politics, trade, culture, and society you are witnessing.

Answer:

Dear Friend,

I hope you are well. I am writing to tell you about my life as a scholar in the court of Akbar.

Our emperor is expanding his empire through wars and alliances. He welcomes many regional rulers and scholars to his court. He also encourages discussions among people of different religions.

Trade is flourishing in our cities and markets. Merchants bring horses, textiles, metals and luxury goods from distant places. Skilled craftspeople produce beautiful clothes, ornaments and other items.

Art, architecture and literature are developing rapidly. Sanskrit books are being translated into Persian, and scholars receive support from the emperor.

However, common people sometimes suffer from heavy taxes and wars. Despite these difficulties, our society continues to work, trade and preserve its traditions.

I hope to hear from you soon.

Your loving friend,

A Scholar

Question 4. How come Akbar, a ruthless conqueror in his young days, grew tolerant and benevolent after some years? What could have led to such a change?

Answer:

Akbar's experience of ruling a large and diverse empire may have helped him understand the importance of cooperation. He realised that force alone could not maintain peace and stability. He began to use diplomacy, marriage alliances and dialogue with different religious communities. He abolished jizya and welcomed regional leaders into his administration. These policies helped him gain wider support.

Question 5. What might have happened if the Vijayanagara Empire had won the Battle of Talikota? Imagine and describe how it could have changed the political and cultural history of south India.

Answer:

If Vijayanagara had won the Battle of Talikota, it might have remained a powerful kingdom in southern India for a longer time. Its capital, Hampi, might not have suffered such widespread destruction. Trade, literature, temple building, music and architecture could have continued to develop under its rulers. The balance of power between Vijayanagara and the Deccan Sultanates might also have changed.

Question 6. Many values promoted by early Sikhism, including equality, seva, and justice, remain relevant today. Select one of these values and discuss how it remains relevant in contemporary society.

Answer:

Equality is an important value in Sikhism. It teaches us that all people deserve equal respect, regardless of their religion, caste, gender or social background. Today, equality is important in schools, workplaces and society. We should treat everyone fairly and give every person equal opportunities. This helps build a peaceful and just society.

Question 7. Imagine you are a trader in a port city (Surat, Calicut or Hooghly). Describe the scenes you see as regards goods, people you trade with, movement of ships, etc.

Answer:

I am a trader living in the port city of Surat. Our port is busy with ships arriving from distant lands. Merchants from Arabia, Persia and Central Asia visit our markets.

We trade in textiles, spices and other Indian goods. We also import horses, silk, metals and luxury items. Workers load and unload goods while sailors prepare their ships for long journeys.

The markets are full of people speaking different languages. Merchants use hundis to transfer money safely without carrying large amounts of cash.

Our port connects India with many parts of the world. Trade provides work to merchants, sailors, craftspeople and labourers.

13. Additional questions from “Let’s Explore” and “Think About It”

These questions appear inside the chapter and may also be useful for classroom discussion and examinations.

Q1. Why did Ala-ud-din Khilji call himself “the second Alexander”?

Answer: Ala-ud-din Khilji wanted to show that he was a great conqueror like Alexander. The title expressed his ambition to win battles and expand his empire.

Q2. What resources were needed to maintain an army in medieval times?

Answer: An army needed weapons, food, horses, elephants, soldiers' salaries, transport, roads and supplies. Money was also needed to build forts and maintain military equipment.

Q3. Why did Harihara and Bukka choose Hampi as their capital, according to popular folklore?

Answer: According to popular folklore, they saw a hare chasing a pack of hounds at Hampi. Their guru, Vidyaranya, interpreted it as a sign of courage and advised them to establish their capital there.

Q4. What do the musical pillars of the Vitthala Temple tell us?

Answer: They show the high level of skill achieved by the sculptors and builders of the Vijayanagara period. They also show the connection between architecture, art and music.

Q5. What was Akbar's translation centre used for?

Answer: Akbar established a translation centre at Fatehpur Sikri to translate important Sanskrit texts into Persian. This helped scholars study Indian literature and ideas across languages.

Q6. Why did Aurangzeb spend many years fighting in the Deccan?

Answer: Aurangzeb wanted to expand and strengthen Mughal control in southern India. However, these long military campaigns consumed large amounts of money and weakened the empire's administration.

Q7. What can we learn from the Ahom victory at Saraighat?

Answer: We can learn that good leadership, knowledge of the local environment, teamwork and effective planning can help a smaller force defeat a larger enemy.

Q8. How did the paik system help the Ahom rulers?

Answer: It provided labour for public works and soldiers for the army. This allowed the rulers to maintain a large military force without depending entirely on a permanent army.

Q9. What values did Guru Gobind Singh and the Khalsa represent?

Answer: They represented courage, equality, justice, service and the defence of religious faith.

Q10. How did the hundi system support merchants?

Answer: It allowed merchants to transfer money across distant places without physically carrying cash. This made trade safer and more convenient.

Q11. Why were temples important beyond religious worship?

Answer: Temples supported markets, education, performing arts, irrigation, pilgrim accommodation and trade. They were important centres of economic and social life.

Q12. What is meant by India's shared cultural heritage during this period?

Answer: It means that different communities interacted with one another, preserved their own traditions and influenced one another's art, literature, architecture and other cultural practices.

14. Additional exam-oriented questions

Very short-answer questions

Q1. Who defeated Ibrahim Lodi in 1526?

Answer: Babur.

Q2. Who wrote the Baburnama?

Answer: Babur.

Q3. Who built Kumbhalgarh Fort?

Answer: Rana Kumbha.

Q4. Who was the Ahom commander at Saraighat?

Answer: Lachit Borphukan.

Q5. Who established the Khalsa?

Answer: Guru Gobind Singh.

Q6. Who was Akbar's finance minister?

Answer: Todar Mal.

Q7. What does sulh-i-kul mean?

Answer: Peace with all.

Q8. What was the capital of the Vijayanagara Empire?

Answer: Vijayanagara, at present-day Hampi.

Q9. Who defeated Rana Sanga at Khanwa?

Answer: Babur.

Q10. Which emperor built the Taj Mahal?

Answer: Shah Jahan.

Short-answer questions

Q11. Why was the First Battle of Panipat important?

Answer: It ended the rule of Ibrahim Lodi, brought the Delhi Sultanate to an end and laid the foundation of the Mughal Empire.

Q12. How did trade continue despite political instability?

Answer: Merchants used trade networks, credit systems and hundis to conduct business across different kingdoms. Important ports connected India with foreign markets.

Q13. How did regional kingdoms protect their independence?

Answer: They maintained armies, formed alliances, used their knowledge of local geography and resisted invasions through wars and guerrilla tactics.

Q14. Why did Mughal power decline after Aurangzeb?

Answer: Long wars drained the treasury, while rebellions and resistance from regional powers weakened Mughal authority.

Q15. What were two positive and two negative effects of this period?

Answer: Positive effects included the growth of trade and the development of art and architecture. Negative effects included destruction caused by wars and the hardships of heavy taxation and religious persecution.

Long-answer questions

Q16. Explain the main changes in India's political map during this period.

Answer: India's political map changed because of foreign invasions, military conquests, the rise of new dynasties and resistance from regional kingdoms. The Delhi Sultanate expanded across parts of northern India but faced resistance from the Eastern Gangas, Hoysalas and Rajputs. The Vijayanagara and Bahmani kingdoms became important powers in the Deccan. Babur established Mughal rule in 1526, and the Mughal Empire expanded under Akbar and Aurangzeb. The Ahoms, Rajputs and Sikhs also defended their territories. These developments continually changed the political boundaries of India.

Q17. Explain the economic life of people between the 13th and 17th centuries.

Answer: Agriculture was the main source of income and government revenue. Irrigation helped farmers grow food crops and commercial crops. Craftspeople produced textiles, weapons, utensils and ornaments. Indian goods were exported through ports such as Surat, Calicut and Hooghly. Merchants used hundis to transfer money safely. Temples supported markets and other economic activities. However, heavy taxes, famines and wars caused hardship for many peasants, craftspeople and labourers.

Q18. Describe the contributions of Akbar to administration and culture.

Answer: Akbar reorganised the administration, introduced the mansabdari system and improved revenue collection with the help of Todar Mal. He divided the empire into provinces and appointed officials to manage different departments. He also encouraged religious dialogue, abolished jizya and formed alliances with regional rulers. He supported scholars and arranged for important Sanskrit texts to be translated into Persian. His policies helped strengthen the empire and encouraged cultural exchange.

15. Quick revision: Five points to remember

- Political change: The Delhi Sultanate, Vijayanagara, the Mughals and regional kingdoms reshaped India's political boundaries.
- Resistance: The Rajputs, Ahoms, tribal communities and Sikhs resisted powerful rulers in different ways.
- Administration: The iqta system belonged to the Delhi Sultanate, while the mansabdari system was associated with Akbar's Mughal administration.
- Economy: Agriculture, crafts, ports, trade and hundis supported economic life.
- Society and culture: The period brought hardships as well as achievements in architecture, literature, music, painting and cultural interaction.

Study tip: First learn the short answers and important dates. Then practise Questions 1–7 from the textbook exercise on page 59, because they cover the chapter's main themes and require you to explain ideas in your own words.